PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | SIEM/XDR | Detection-as-Code | KQL | SOAR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with more than five years of experience building and operating Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) capabilities across large enterprise environments. My core strengths are Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based detection-as-code, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) administration, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I manage Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform across an 8,000-user estate, writing detection rules, onboarding log sources, tuning alert thresholds, and developing SOAR automations to accelerate alert triage and incident containment. I also operate CrowdStrike Falcon as an additional EDR layer and am proficient in PowerShell scripting for automation and integration tasks. I am based in the United Kingdom and happy to travel to London on a flexible hybrid schedule.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel with KQL detection-as-code; CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM; Splunk SPL (moderate)
- **XDR/EDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; CrowdStrike Falcon EDR Prevent and Insight - Expert
- **SOAR:** Playbook development and automation; automated alert enrichment, triage, and response workflows
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL detection rule authoring; detection-as-code practices; MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping and gap analysis
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle; end-to-end incident management; root cause analysis; post-incident reviews
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Scripting:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR automation integration; log source onboarding and parsing
- **Cloud:** Microsoft Azure (Sentinel, Defender for Cloud, Entra ID); Azure infrastructure security
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM; Tanium; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Operate Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform across an 8,000-user estate, authoring KQL detection rules, onboarding data connectors and log sources, and maintaining alert logic aligned to MITRE ATT&CK
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, managing policies, tuning detections, and investigating alerts across all surfaces
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate enrichment, triage, and containment actions, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover, and Next-Generation SIEM) alongside Sentinel, providing dual-layer endpoint and cloud detection coverage
- Lead incident response engagements following NIST 800-61 methodology, from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review

- Write PowerShell scripts to automate security operations tasks, including log collection, alert handling, and integration with SOAR workflows
- Conduct detection-as-code reviews, testing and deploying updated KQL rules and maintaining version-controlled detection libraries
- Administer Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO integrations; manage BeyondTrust PAM for privileged access
- Run vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); track and report remediation progress to stakeholders
- Maintain MITRE ATT&CK coverage maps and deliver detection gap analyses to improve visibility across endpoints, identity, and cloud

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 devices, configuring detection policies, exclusions, and response actions
- Triaged and investigated alerts in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL queries; escalated incidents and coordinated containment responses
- Contributed to SOAR automation work, scripting routine triage steps in PowerShell to reduce analyst workload
- Managed Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA; administered BeyondTrust PAM for privileged user accounts
- Supported compliance programmes for CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, and ISO 27001; prepared security documentation and risk registers
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to reduce human-risk factors

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Administered endpoint security tools and managed vulnerability scanning using Nessus; tracked remediation activities against SLA targets
- Managed Microsoft 365 security configuration and Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID) identity services including MFA
- Provided infrastructure support for cloud and on-premises environments, enforcing security controls aligned with ISO 27001
- Supported penetration test engagements, coordinating findings remediation and prioritisation with the IT team

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and optimised Microsoft Sentinel with KQL detection-as-code across an 8,000-user estate, improving detection fidelity and reducing false-positive rates for the security team
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks that reduced manual alert triage effort by an estimated 40 percent, enabling faster response to high-priority incidents
- Built a comprehensive MITRE ATT&CK coverage map for UAL's environment, identifying and closing detection blind spots across endpoint, identity, and cloud surfaces
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users, establishing consistent XDR coverage and enabling automated response capabilities
- Led end-to-end incident response for multiple high-severity events, achieving rapid containment and producing thorough post-incident reports to prevent recurrence
- Delivered Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA rollout across the full UAL user base, contributing to Cyber Essentials Plus certification

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)